



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's learn the nicknames of Boston.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people and places in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know of any nicknames for your city?
- What do they mean?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about places and attractions in a city.
- I can talk or report about actions, events or people.
- I can say what I was doing when something else happened.





Let's Explore!

Is there a **nickname*** for our city?

* A "nickname" is a fun name or just another name people give to a person or a city.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** We turned America's Walking City into our cycling city.
Peter: Yeah, many attractions were built downtown. That's why the city is also called the Hub. I'm ready for a latte break.
- Sally:** Boston has so many interesting nicknames. It's really a City Upon a Hill. I was thinking about that on my bike when a new hill approached me.
Peter: I like the City of Champions the best. Our baseball, basketball and football teams all won championships in the last 10 years.
- Sally:** Yeah, you're such a sports fan. I didn't like sports when I was a child.
Peter: In my childhood, when my parents worked on the yard, I was always watching sports games on TV.
- Sally:** Well, I don't think we're so much the Puritan City anymore.
Peter: But we ARE still the Athens of America. As the city expanded, the locals were also developing their cultural interests.





Let's Practice!

Let's learn Boston's nicknames.

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the phrases.

Word Bank

Hut / Hub / Puritan / Walking / Champions / Athens / Hill / Pure

1. America's _____ City
2. The _____
3. City Upon a _____
4. City of _____
5. _____ City
6. _____ of America



Let's Practice!

Sally and Peter talk more about the city they love.

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Find and fix the mistakes in the sentences below. Each sentence has 1 mistake.

1. We turn America's Walking City into our cycling city.
2. Many of Boston's attractions were build in the Hub, which is downtown.
3. Our professional sports teams all one championships in the last 10 years.
4. I don't like sports when I was a child.





Extension Activity

Explain the nicknames in your city.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Ask friends or family about any nicknames there are for your city, past or present.
- Write a sentence about each nickname. Explain the reason for it.
- Make up a new nickname for your city. Write in a sentence why it should have that nickname.
- Tell your partner in English about the new nickname. Ask if they agree.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I inquire about nicknames for my city.

☐ ☐

I write statements explaining the nicknames.

☐ ☐

I create a new English nickname for my city and explain the reason.

☐ ☐

I discuss the new nickname with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to approach** (verb): to move closer
e.g. As Sally approached the hill on her bike, she knew it would be tough riding up.
- latte** (noun): a specialty coffee made with $\frac{1}{4}$ espresso and $\frac{3}{4}$ steamed milk
e.g. Sally loves her latte every morning.
- champion** (noun): the winner of the final game of the sports season
e.g. The Boston Red Sox were Major League Baseball champions in 2014.
- hockey** (noun): a team sport played on ice with 6 players on each side using a small black round object called a puck, and a stick
e.g. The Boston Bruins is the city's champion hockey team.
- yard** (noun): the grass space surrounding the home often planted with trees and flowers
e.g. Families love to keep their yards beautiful to sit and play in.
- to expand** (verb): to increase in size and population
e.g. Boston expanded a lot over the years.
- local** (noun): a person who is from a particular city
e.g. The locals of Boston are really proud of their culture and sports teams.



Learning Points

Past Tense and Past Continuous tense

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about events that are finished.

You use the Past Continuous to talk about events or an action that was happening at a time in the past.

Simple Past tense verbs can be regular or irregular.

Regular verbs end in *-ed* or *-ied*.

Irregular verbs change in different ways.

For questions in the past, you use the auxiliary *did* followed by the verb in the base form, like *Did you ask ... ?*

Did is the past form of *to do*.

For Past Continuous, we add *was/were + verb -ing* to verbs.

Some verbs need a change to the last letter to add *-ing*.

Present tense	Past tense	Present Continuous tense
turn	turned	was/were turning
build	built	was/were building
think	thought	was/were thinking
approach	approached	was/were approaching
win	won	was/were winning
expand	expanded	was/were expanding

Examples:

- I was always watching sports games on TV when my parents called me to do homework.*
- Many attractions were built downtown.*
- Sally was thinking about the name, a City Upon a Hill, when she approached a new hill.*

